$|A_1| = |A| + p(0) + q(0) = |A|$ (using Property 4)

Therefore $|A_1| = |A|$

This property is independent of any fixed row or column. ■

Example 7.18

If a, b, c and x are positive real numbers, then show that $\begin{vmatrix} (a^x+a^{-x})^2 & (a^x-a^{-x})^2 & 1 \\ (b^x+b^{-x})^2 & (b^x-b^{-x})^2 & 1 \\ (c^x+c^{-x})^2 & (c^x-c^{-x})^2 & 1 \end{vmatrix}$ is zero.

Solution

Applying $C_1 \to C_1 - C_2$, we get $\begin{vmatrix} 4 & (a^x-a^{-x})^2 & 1 \\ 4 & (b^x-b^{-x})^2 & 1 \\ 4 & (c^x-c^{-x})^2 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = 0$, since C_1 and C_3 are proportional.

Example 7.19

Without expanding the determinants, show that $|B| = 2|A|$.

Where $B = \begin{bmatrix} b+c & c+a & a+b \\ c+a & a+b & b+c \\ a+b & b+c & c+a \end{bmatrix}$ and $A = \begin{bmatrix} a & b & c \\ b & c & a \\ c & a & b \end{bmatrix}$

Solution

We have $|B| = \begin{vmatrix} 2(a+b+c) & 2(a+b+c) & 2(a+b+c) \\ c+a & a+b & b+c \\ a+b & b+c & c+a \end{vmatrix} (R_1 \to R_1 + R_2 + R_3)$

$= 2\begin{vmatrix} a+b+c & a+b+c & a+b+c \\ c+a & a+b & b+c \\ a+b & b+c & c+a \end{vmatrix}$

$= 2\begin{vmatrix} a+b+c & a+b+c & a+b+c \\ -b & -c & -a \\ -c & -a & -b \end{vmatrix} (R_2 \to R_2 - R_1 \text{ and } R_3 \to R_3 - R_1)$

$= 2\begin{vmatrix} a & b & c \\ -b & -c & -a \\ -c & -a & -b \end{vmatrix} (R_1 \to R_1 + R_2 + R_3)$

$= 2(-1)^2\begin{vmatrix} a & b & c \\ b & c & a \\ c & a & b \end{vmatrix}$

$= 2|A|$.

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